

The Consultation Room

Ethics, communication, and the trust a client hands you before you ever touch her hands

Learning Objectives

- Explain informed consent for extensions, including maintenance and removal commitment
- Set honest expectations when a client's natural nails cannot safely support her request
- Respond to nail-biting and related behaviour with care rather than judgment
- Handle photo consent directly and respectfully

A service that lasts weeks deserves a longer conversation

Unlike most single-appointment services in this Atelier, extensions and gel systems create an ongoing relationship between a client's natural nail and a product she will carry for weeks — and that relationship deserves a fuller, more honest conversation than "what colour would you like today?"

Informed consent for extensions

Before applying any extension system, a client should understand, in plain language: the maintenance schedule required (typically every two to three weeks) to avoid lifting and fungal risk in the gap between natural growth and product, that improper soak-off removal by anyone, including at home, risks the damage taught in Module Six, and that natural nails underneath extensions need periodic breaks to recover fully, per Module Six's cumulative-damage principle. This is not a sales conversation. It is the same respect for informed choice taught throughout this Atelier.

When a request outpaces the natural nail's capacity

A client with significantly bitten, thin, or damaged natural nails requesting long, dramatic extensions presents a genuine structural risk — the extension's weight and length can pull excessively on a compromised natural nail, risking further damage or even natural nail loss. The honest response is not automatic refusal, and not silent compliance either: explain plainly what the natural nail can currently support, offer a shorter, more structurally realistic length as a starting point, and frame length growth as a staged plan as her natural nails strengthen and recover, mirroring the staged-service honesty taught in Course II, Module Ten.

A Note from Practice

A client requests long, dramatic stiletto extensions, but her natural nails are visibly and significantly bitten down to short, thin beds. Applying the requested length as asked would place enormous mechanical stress on nails not currently strong enough to bear it, risking further loss.

The Amber-trained response: acknowledge what she's asking for warmly, explain honestly what her current natural nails can safely support today, and offer a shorter, protective extension as a first step with a plan to lengthen gradually as her natural nail strengthens beneath it — giving her the confidence of extensions immediately, without setting her up for a painful loss a few weeks later.

Nail-biting and related behaviour, held with care

Nail-biting (onychophagia) and skin-picking around the nails are frequently linked to anxiety, stress, or, in some cases, body-focused repetitive behaviour disorders — not a simple bad habit a client has failed to break through willpower alone. Avoid scolding language ("you really need to stop doing this to yourself") entirely. A protective extension service can genuinely help by providing a physical barrier during the habit-breaking process, and a warm, non-judgmental mention that support exists for this pattern, offered gently and only if it feels appropriate, can matter more than any product recommendation.

Photo consent

As in Course III, ask directly and specifically before posting any completed look publicly, and document consent in writing for planned portfolio use. Respect a "no" immediately and completely.

Key Terms

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[object Object]

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[object Object]

Practical Activity · The Honest Consultation

With a partner, roleplay the dramatic-extension-on-bitten-nails scenario from this module's case study. Practice offering the staged plan warmly, without either refusing outright or complying against your professional judgment.